A Broken Freedom

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Let freedom ring as mighty as our liberty bell.
The people sing: Give me liberty, or give me death!
Let freedom ring across highs and lows, above and below
all lands, all people, all pursuits of happiness.

Crack, the liberty bell groans, an undetected defect
snapping its exterior. Let freedom ring, the people
demand, behind the bell jar without any sound.
This bell is merely symbolic, the government says,

ushering the people to ring the king instead. No kings,
the people protest, no dictators! Their diction is lost
in the noise of uncertain revolution. Let freedom ring,
our revolutionary founding fathers once said.

What would they say about our broken silence?
They said: Give me liberty, or give me death.
We Americans chose death. We would rather die
for our country than die for our convictions.

Where were the revolutionaries during the Revolution?
Where are we? The liberty bell may be broken
but we can still be outspoken. Let us learn from the French
and stand by liberté, égalité, and fraternité for all.